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APPS



**WhatsApp adds new
features to protect
against scams**

WhatsApp is introducing new features to help people spot scams on the messaging service, the company announced on Tuesday. The company also said it has taken down over 6.8 million WhatsApp accounts linked to criminal scam centers targeting people around the world.

The new features are designed to help detect scams in both group and individual chats on the Meta-owned platform.

For group chats, WhatsApp is launching a safety overview feature that will be displayed when someone who isn't in your contact list adds you to a new group that you may not recognize. The safety overview will include key information about the group, alongside tips to stay safe.

For example, you will see if the person who added you is one of your contacts, and if any member of the group is a contact of yours.

If you decide that you might recognize the group, you can choose to see the chat for more context. Either way, notifications from the chat will be muted until you mark that you want to remain in the group.

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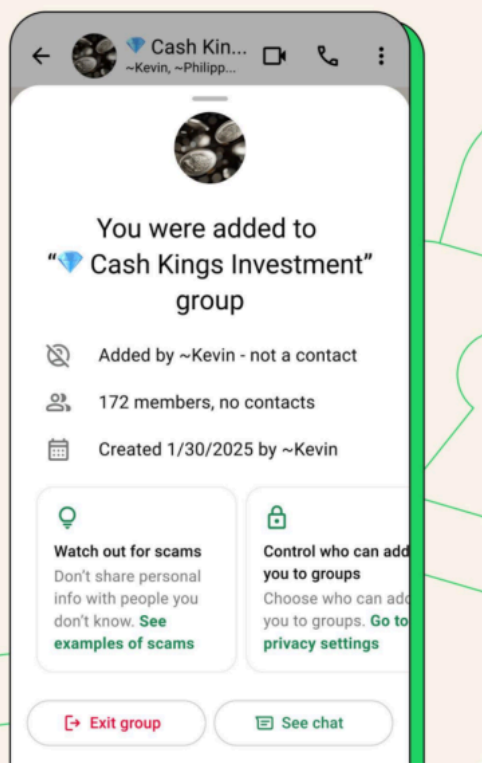
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IMAGE CREDITS:WHATSAPP

As for individual chats, WhatsApp notes that scammers might try to start conversations with you elsewhere on the internet before asking to message on private messaging services like WhatsApp. To protect against this tactic, the app is testing new ways to alert people before they start talking to someone who could be trying to scam them.

For example, it's working to caution users when they start a chat with someone not in their contacts by showing them additional context about who they're messaging.

WhatsApp also shared information about how it worked alongside OpenAI to disrupt scam efforts that were traced back to a scam center in Cambodia.

“These attempts ranged from offering payments for fake likes to enlisting others into a rent-a-scooter pyramid scheme, or luring people to invest in cryptocurrency,” WhatsApp explained in a [blog post](#).

“As OpenAI reported, the scammers used ChatGPT to generate the initial text message containing a link to a WhatsApp chat, and then quickly directed the target to Telegram, where they were assigned a task of liking videos on TikTok. The scammers attempted to build trust in their scheme by sharing how much the target has already ‘earned’ in theory, before asking them to deposit money into a crypto account as the next task.”

WhatsApp says users can protect themselves from scams by taking time before responding to think about whether the message reads like a legitimate task. They should then question if the request makes sense and if they’re rushing you into taking action. If they’re claiming to be a friend or family member, you should use another method of communication to verify their identity.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Meta](#) [WhatsApp](#)



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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WhatsApp introduces new features across chats, calls, and channels

Aisha Malik — 8:08 AM PDT · April 10, 2025

WhatsApp has [announced](#) a slew of new updates across chats, calls, and channels designed to enhance the messaging and calling experience for users as it continues to compete with popular services like Telegram and Discord.

Among the most notable additions is an “Online” indicator that appears at the top of a group chat to show you how many people are currently around to chat.

Another new group chat feature will allow you to highlight certain notifications, as you can now use a newly added “Notify for” setting and select “Highlights” to limit notifications for @mentions, replies, and messages from saved contacts or “All” to receive all notifications.

Another feature offers the option to scan and send documents on an iPhone. To access this, users select “scan document” from the attachment

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options and then follow the steps to scan, crop, and save the document.

Also, iPhone users can now set WhatsApp as their default messaging and calling app. Plus, iPhone users can now pinch to zoom in during video calls.



IMAGE CREDITS: WHATSAPP

As for video calls, WhatsApp says it upgraded its technology to make video calls more reliable and of higher quality, which should lead to reduced dropped calls and video freezing. The app's improved bandwidth detection should also allow for more HD-quality video calls.

While WhatsApp has allowed users to create events in group chats for some time now, it's now rolling out the ability to create an event in 1:1 conversations. Plus, the events feature is getting updated with the ability to RSVP as "maybe," invite a plus one, add an end date and time, and pin events so they're easier to find.

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In addition, you can now add someone to an ongoing 1:1 call from a chat thread by tapping the call icon at the top of your screen and then selecting "Add to call."

Channels are also getting three updates, as admins can now record and share short videos with followers and share unique QR codes that link directly to their channel. Plus, you can now get a written summary of voice message updates from channels to get yourself up to speed when you're on the go and unable to read individual messages.

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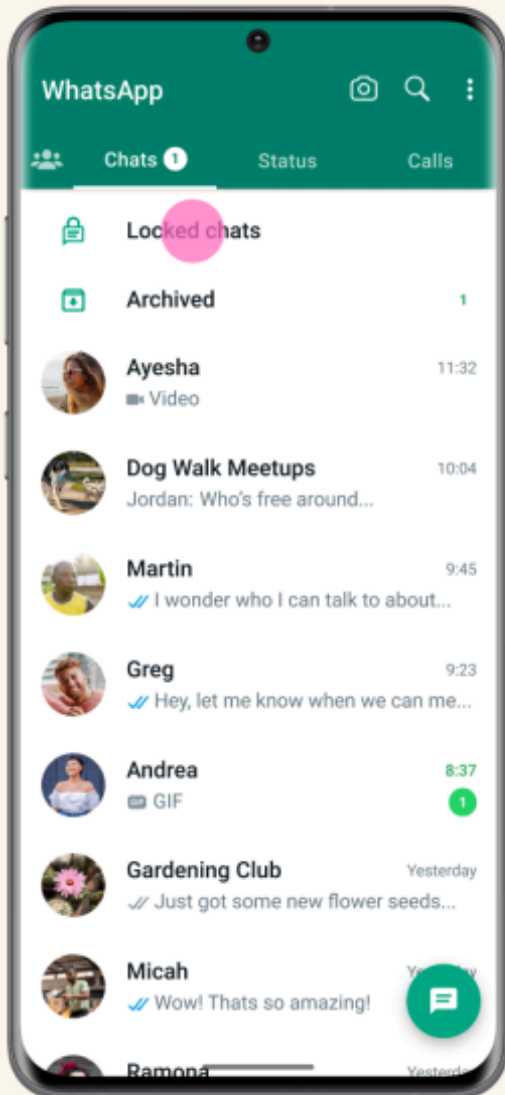
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WhatsApp now lets you lock and hide individual chats

Aisha Malik — 10:44 AM PDT · May 15, 2023

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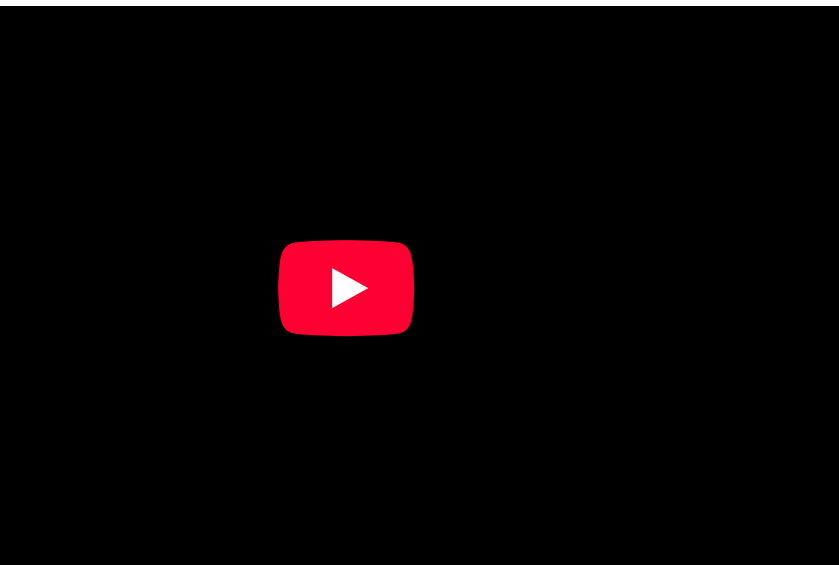
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notifications. You can lock a chat by tapping the name of a one-to-one or group and selecting the lock option. To reveal these chats, you have to slowly pull down on your inbox and enter your phone password or biometric.



“We think this feature will be great for people who have reason to share their phones from time to time with a family member or those moments where someone else is holding your phone at the exact moment an extra special chat arrives,” the company wrote in a [blog post](#).

The Meta-owned company says it plans to add more options for Chat Lock, including locking for companion devices and creating a custom password for your chats so that you can use a unique password different from the one you use for your phone.

Although WhatsApp offers end-to-end encryption, that doesn’t apply when someone has unlocked access to your phone and can see your messages.

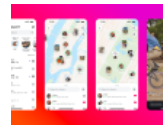
AI



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Aisha Malik - 15 hours ago

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Aisha Malik - 19 hours ago

The new feature provides an extra layer of security in these instances.

The new feature comes a few weeks after WhatsApp added [a few new updates around polls and sharing](#) on its platform. As part of these updates, you now have the option to create single-vote polls, which means you can run a poll where people are only allowed to vote once. As for sharing, you can now forward media with captions.

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WhatsApp now lets you create single-vote polls and forward media with captions



WhatsApp is adding a few new updates around polls and sharing on its platform, the company announced on Thursday. Most notably, you can now create single-vote polls and forward media with captions. You now have the option to create single-vote polls, which means you can run a poll where people are only allowed to vote [Continue reading](#)

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WhatsApp is preparing to roll out third-party chat support

Ivan Mehta — 3:35 AM PST · February 7, 2024

A month away from the Digital Markets Act (DMA) deadline, WhatsApp is preparing to allow other messaging networks in its app.

In an interview with [Wired](#), Dick Brouwer, an engineering director at WhatsApp, said that the company is ready to offer interoperability on the platform with over 2 billion users.

IMAGE CREDITS:

AP Photo/Julian Fernandez, Getty Images

“There’s real tension between offering an easy way to offer this interoperability to third parties whilst at the same time preserving the WhatsApp privacy, security, and integrity bar. I think we’re pretty happy with where we’ve landed,” he told the publication.

The EU agreed upon [including messaging interoperability](#) under DMA in 2022. This rule mandates gatekeepers like WhatsApp and Messenger to open up their services to other chat apps.

Meta is also working to add support for other chat apps to Messenger. Initially, these experiences will focus on one-on-one chats where people can send text, audio, video, images and files across apps. As

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[WABetaInfo](#) reported before, this experience will live in a new sub-menu on top of the inbox called [“Third-party chats.”](#)

Brouwer, who worked on [rolling out end-to-end encryption for Messenger last year](#), told Wired that this will be an opt-in experience to avoid spam and scams.

“I can choose whether or not I want to participate in being open to exchanging messages with third parties. This is important, because it could be a big source of spam and scams,” he said.

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Companies that want to be interoperable with Meta's system will have to sign an agreement, details of which are not public yet. WhatsApp will require end-to-end encryption to enable interoperability. However, Apple's recently announced changes to the App Store could serve as an indicator that the terms might not be straightforward.

Recently, open source messaging protocol Matrix's founder Matthew Hodgson [noted at a talk](#) that it has worked with WhatsApp on an "experimental" basis to make the protocol work with end-to-end encryption intact.



It's not clear if other operators like Telegram, Viber and Google are planning to add interoperability support with WhatsApp.

Brouwer told Wired that third-party chats and WhatsApp native chats might not reach feature parity as interoperability could open up new privacy and security issues.

Apps that bring in multiple messaging services under one umbrella has been in the spotlight for the

last few months. Last October, WordPress.com owner [Automattic bought Texts.com for \\$50 million](#). Pebble smartwatch founder Eric Migicovsky's Beeper has been in [conversation for its effort — which Apple shut down — to bring iMessage to Android phones](#).

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Ivan Mehta



Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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